75, a coda is added, founded chiefly on the countersubject, but with an altered entry of the subject in the bass from bar 79.

The episodes of this fugue are all founded on material suggested by the countersubject. They are five in number: bars 17 to 20, 24 to 28, 40 to 45, 55 to 59 and 63 to 67.

FUGUE 41 (Book II, 17)

A FLAT MAJOR (FOUR VOICES).

Exposition.—The subject is in the alto:—



The answer is **tonal**, but (as with so many others) it is only the first note which needs alteration. The countersubject commences on the second beat of bar 3 and closes with the subject, at the beginning of bar 5. There is a bar of codetta, founded on the subject. The remaining entries in the exposition are at bars 6 and 8. The order of the voices is not quite one of the most usual, alto, treble, tenor, bass. An episode (bars 10 to 13), separates the exposition from the counter-exposition.

Counter-Exposition.—The subject again leads (bar 13), but now in the bass, and with the countersubject inverted at the twelfth (in the tenor), which necessitates the change of a D flat to D natural in the subject. The answer follows in the alto (bar 16) then the subject in the tenor (bar 18) and finally, after a codetta, the subject again in the treble. The countersubject is always present, though incomplete.

Ebenezer Prout: Analysis of J. S. Bach's Forty-Eight Fugues
Ed. Louis B. Prout. London: Edwin Ashdown, 1910. Printed pp. 77-78.
BWV 886. Complete original pages; adjoining commentary is retained.
Full source scan

Middle Section.—This follows immediately, the subject being presented in the alto in the key of F minor, with countersubject in the treble. The second and last episode (bars 26 to 32) is formed from the last member of the subject. The next appearance of the subject is at bar 32 in the tenor, in the unrelated key of E flat minor, and unaccompanied by the countersubject. The entry at bar 35 in the treble, in the key of B flat minor, may be regarded as the answer to the preceding, though real instead of tonal; the countersubject is in the alto. Next follows an entry in the bass in D flat (bar 37), with a portion of the countersubject in the treble.

Final Section.—The subject returns in the key of A flat in the tenor in bar 41, with the countersubject, curiously varied, in the treble; and is answered in stretto by the bass in bar 42. There is a coda from bar 46 to the end, containing an entry of the answer (but in the tonic key) in the tenor at bar 48, where a fifth voice is added, the first bass taking a part of the countersubject while the second supplies the harmonic bass.

Although nominally a four-part fugue, there is a great predominance of three-part writing, less than one-third of the whole being really in four parts.

FUGUE 42 (Book II, 18)

G SHARP MINOR (THREE VOICES).

One of the longest and most elaborate of the forty-eight, although containing no stretto. It is virtually a double fugue, its second subject (or countersubject) having a separate exposition from bar 61 to 83, only slightly irregular at bars 71 to 75. Contrast the very irregular entries of the new themes in No. 38.